attendify

User Manual

A QR-based attendance monitoring system for educational institutions.

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Getting Started

First-Time Setup

When Attendify is first deployed, navigate to /new in your browser. The setup wizard can do the following:

1. Configure your institution settings, including **name** and **logo**.
2. Create the first administrator account with **name**, **email**, and **password**.
3. Upon completion, you will be redirected to the login page.

Logging In

1. Go to “/login”.
2. Enter your registered **email** and **password**.
3. Click the **Sign In** button.

Note: If you've forgotten your password, use the "Forgot your password?" link to reset it.

Logging Out

1. Click the **Logout** button located in the sidebar or drawer.
2. A confirmation dialog will appear to verify your sign-out request.

Admin Role

Administrators have comprehensive control over the Attendify system, managing users, settings, reports, and activity logs.

Dashboard Statistics

The admin dashboard provides a high-level overview of key system metrics:

- **Total Users:** The total number of registered users across all roles.
- **Teachers:** The number of active teacher accounts.
- **Students:** The number of active student accounts.
- **Pending Invitations:** The number of open invitations that have not yet been accepted.

User Management

Navigate to **Manage Users** to access user management features.

- **Viewing Users:** All users are listed with their name, email, role badge, and status badge. Click any user to open their profile page.
- **Inviting New Users:**
  a. Click the **Invite User** button located at the top-right of the **Users** page.
  b. Fill in the required information: **Full Name** (optional), **Email Address**, and **Role** (Admin/Teacher/Student).
  c. Use the **+ Add Another** button to add multiple users at once.
  d. A secure acceptance link will be generated and sent to each invitee, valid for 7 days.
  e. The user list updates in real-time every 20 seconds.
- **Managing Invitations:** View invitee details, role, and expiry date. Invalidate invitations using the ✕ button.
- **Blocking & Archiving:** Block prevents user login. Unblock restores access. Archive soft-deactivates an account. Note that you cannot block or archive your own account.

Reports

Navigate to **Reports** to access attendance data and analytics.

- **Attendance Overview:** Aggregated attendance statistics across all classes.
- **Export CSV:** Download raw attendance data in CSV format.
- **Export PDF:** Download a formatted PDF report.
- **Class Overview (Leaderboard):** Attendance performance ranked across all classes.

Activity Log

The activity log records all significant actions performed within the system, including user creation, invitations, class creation, and attendance marking. Use the filter and browse features to audit changes.

Site Settings

Update the institution's name, logo, and other global configurations within the Site Settings section.

Teacher Role

Teachers manage classes, schedule sessions, and review excuse requests.

Dashboard Statistics

The teacher dashboard provides a summary of relevant information:

- **My Classes:** The number of active classes owned by the teacher.
- **Sessions Today:** The number of class sessions scheduled or active for the current day.
- **Pending Excuses:** The number of excuse requests awaiting review.
- **Total Students:** The total number of enrolled students across all classes.

Managing Classes

Navigate to **My Classes** to manage your classes.

- **Creating a Class:**
  a. Click the **New Class** button.
  b. Enter the class **Name**, **Description** (optional), and **Section** (optional).
  c. Click **Create Class**.
- **Class Detail Page:** View enrolled students with attendance summaries, schedule sessions (individual or bulk recurring), view analytics with charts, export PDF analytics, and archive the class.
- **Enrolling/Removing Students:** Use the **Search & Add Student** input to find and enroll students by name or email. Click the ✕ button to unenroll a student.

Managing Sessions

- **Scheduling:**
  a. Click **Add Session**.
  b. Choose the **Modality** (Onsite/Online).
  c. Enter the **Location**, that being the room number or platform link (optional).
  d. Set the **Start Time**, **End Time**, and **Grace Period** (default is 15 minutes).
  e. Click **Save**.
- **Starting a Session:** Click **Start Session** to activate the QR code for student scanning.
- **Viewing a Session:** Real-time attendance list (Present, Late, Absent, Excused), active QR code display, and manual attendance override capability.
- **Platform-agnostic QR:** The QR code encodes a public attendance URL. Students can scan it with any QR reader app, which will take them to a web page to enter their email address. This works on any device with a browser, and no Attendify login is required.

Excuse Requests

Navigate to **Excuse Requests** to manage student excuses.

- Approve an excuse to change the student's status to Excused.
- Deny an excuse with an optional note.
- Download uploaded supporting documents, such as medical certificates.

Student Role

Students enroll in classes, scan QR codes for attendance, and submit excuses.

Dashboard Statistics

The student dashboard provides a summary of your academic engagement:

- **My Classes:** The number of classes you are enrolled in.
- **Sessions This Week:** The number of sessions scheduled for the current week.
- **Attendance Rate:** Your overall attendance percentage.
- **Pending Excuses:** The number of excuse requests that are currently pending review.

Scanning Attendance

- **In-App Scanner:**
  a. Navigate to **Scan QR** located in the sidebar.
  b. Allow camera access when prompted.
  c. Point your camera at the QR code provided by the teacher.
  d. You will receive a success confirmation upon successful scan.
- **Any QR Scanner (Public Link):**
  a. Scan the QR code using your phone's camera or a third-party QR code reader app.
  b. The QR code will open a web page where you can enter your registered email address.
  c. Click **Mark Attendance** to record your attendance.
  d. You will receive a confirmation message.
  e. **Note:** The QR code will expire at the session end time plus the grace period.

Attendance Records

Navigate to **Attendance** to view your complete attendance history across all classes. The history includes the session date/time, your status (Present / Late / Absent / Excused), and the class name.

Calendar

The **Calendar** shows upcoming and past sessions in a monthly calendar layout, helping you plan around scheduled classes.

Submitting an Excuse

1. Go to **My Classes** → select the class → find the specific session.
2. Alternatively, navigate to **Excuses** → **New Excuse Request**.
3. Enter the reason for your absence.
4. Upload supporting documents related to your reason of absence (PDF/image).
5. Submit the request for teacher review.

Notification Preferences

Navigate to the **Notification Preferences** in the sidebar in order to configure your email notifications to stay informed about your classes. You can customize these preferences to notify you of the following:

- Session start notifications
- Weekly attendance summaries
- Parent/guardian absence notifications (if guardian email is configured)

Notification Center

All roles have access to real-time system updates via the **Notification Center**.

Accessing Notifications

1. Click the bell icon ( ) in the sidebar or drawer.
2. A red badge indicates the number of unread notifications. The notification center updates automatically every 15 seconds.

Toast Notifications

Toast notifications are pop-up messages that slide in from the top-right corner of the screen. They display a title and a brief summary of the notification.

- Click on the toast notification to open the relevant page.
- Toast notifications dismiss after 5 seconds, but you can close them manually.

Notification Types

- **For Students:** Class Session Started, Session Completed, Excuse Reviewed, Attendance Updated
- **For Teachers:** Attendance Recorded, Excuse Submitted
- **For Admins:** New User Registered

Managing Notifications

- Unread notifications are highlighted with a colored left border.
- Clicking a notification navigates you to the relevant page and marks the notification as read.
- Use the "Mark all as read" option to clear the unread badge.

Profile Management

All users can manage their profiles by clicking on their name or avatar at the bottom of the sidebar

Editable Fields

The following fields can be edited in your profile:

- **Full Name:** Your display name throughout the system.
- **Email Address:** Used for login and notifications.
- **Password:** Leave this field blank to keep your current password.
- **Avatar:** Upload a square profile photo.
- **Profile Banner:** Upload a wide banner image.
- **Guardian Name (Students):** The name of your parent or guardian.
- **Guardian Email (Students):** The email address for absence notifications.

Viewing Another User's Profile

Click on a user's name anywhere in the system to visit their public profile page, which displays their name, role, avatar, and banner.

Themes & Accessibility

Attendify supports both light and dark themes. Use the theme toggle button (sun/moon icon) located at the bottom of the sidebar (desktop) and mobile drawer to switch between themes. Your theme preference is saved in your browser's “localStorage” and persists across sessions.